

The helpdesk is drowning

Priya runs a two-person IT helpdesk and the queue never stops. Some tickets are ‘my laptop won’t boot before a client demo’ emergencies; others are ‘can I get a bigger monitor.’ Each ticket has a priority and an agreed response time — urgent within 2 hours, normal within a day — and Priya wants to always pick the most pressing ticket next, with anything past its promised time jumping to the front. She’s forever answering ‘what’s overdue?’ and ‘what’s assigned to me?’, and looking up a specific customer’s ticket by name. The list is huge, so she pages through it.

Build Priya something so the right ticket is always on top.

(The way Priya talks about her queue tells you what it needs — the ordering rule is the heart of it. Build it for any helpdesk, not just Priya’s. Get tickets and the queue order right first, then filters and assignment.)

The Twist

Your solution must also include an automated check that escalates any ticket which has breached its agreed response time — raising its priority by one level (normal → high → urgent), at most one level per run.